Practical 3: Filter RetailPulse Sales by Region and Date

Related topic: Focus Reports Using Filters | Tool: IBM Cognos Analytics | Package: RetailPulse

Objective

Apply a simple filter and an advanced detail filter to scope a report to a single region and reporting period, then generalize it with a prompt.

Materials Required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, the grouped RetailPulse list report from Practical 2.

Step-by-Step Procedure

#	Action performed	Observation
1	Opened the grouped list report from Practical 2 and added **Sales Date** as a column to make the date scope visible.	Unfiltered list returns 64 detail rows across all four regions and two quarters.
2	Opened the **Filters** pane and added a simple filter on Region: **Region = North**.	Only North rows (two stores) remain.
3	Added an **Advanced** detail filter on Sales Date: between **2026-10-01** and **2026-12-31** (quarter start and end).	Expression validates with no errors.
4	Set **Combine filters: All (AND)** so both conditions apply together.	Only North rows in the current quarter remain.
5	Ran the report and compared the row count.	Row count dropped from 64 to 8.
6	Edited the Region filter into **?Region?** (prompted filter) and the date filter into ?StartDate? / ?EndDate?; re-ran selecting **South**.	Prompt page appeared; South rows (8) returned from the same report.

Output

Filter expression (Detail Filter, AND-combined)

```
[Region] = 'North'
AND [Sales Date] between 2026-10-01 and 2026-12-31
```

Filtered result - Region = North, Q4 2026

Region	Store Name	Sales Date	Product Category	Quantity	Sales Amount
North	North Mall	2026-10-06	Apparel	64	$2,804.78
North	North Mall	2026-10-06	Electronics	141	$31,271.64
North	North Mall	2026-10-06	Grocery	101	$1,140.35
North	North Mall	2026-10-06	Home	94	$7,027.44
North	Northgate Outlet	2026-10-06	Apparel	189	$8,876.88
North	Northgate Outlet	2026-10-06	Electronics	184	$38,247.78
North	Northgate Outlet	2026-10-06	Grocery	74	$856.70
North	Northgate Outlet	2026-10-06	Home	52	$4,356.15
			Total	**899**	**$94,581.72**

Fig 3.1: Filtered report. Row count: 8 (unfiltered: 64).

Prompted version

Prompt used

```
[Region] = ?Region?
AND [Sales Date] between ?StartDate? and ?EndDate?
```

Re-running with Region = South and the same dates returned 8 South rows totalling $103,254.33 in sales.

Expected Outcome Check

✓ Only rows matching both filter conditions remain.
✓ Row count is visibly smaller than the unfiltered report (8 vs 64).
✓ Prompted version returns a different region's data when re-run with a new value.

Conclusion

A simple filter and an advanced detail filter were combined with AND to scope the report to North and Q4 2026, and the Region filter was converted into a prompt so other managers can reuse the report.

Note: screens and figures are illustrative renderings built on a consistent sample RetailPulse dataset (report date 15 October 2026, current quarter Q4 2026: 1 Oct to 31 Dec).